

EVA CHEN

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Education

Expected 2028	Columbia University PhD, Sociology Dissertation: “Neither Here nor There: Three Essays on Adaptation, Settlement, and Belonging among Temporary Immigrants” Committee: Jennifer Lee, Mario Small (co-chair), Xi Song (co-chair), Marissa Thompson	<i>New York, NY</i>
2026	MPhil, Sociology Thesis: “Precarious Lives: Temporality & Assimilation among Chinese International Students” Committee: Mario Small (chair), Xi Song Field statement (written qualifying exam): “Assimilation in the 21st Century: Transnationalism, Liminality, and Belonging”	
2024	MA, Sociology	
2020	University of Minnesota Twin Cities BA with high distinction, Political Science and Global Studies, <i>summa cum laude</i> Minor, Asian & Middle Eastern Studies (Japanese) Thesis: “Assimilation and Voting Behavior among Asian Americans” Committee: Christopher Federico, Paul Goren (chair), Michael Minta	<i>Minneapolis, MN</i>
2019	East China Normal University Semester exchange student, China Studies	<i>Shanghai, China</i>

Research Areas

Migration; Race & Ethnicity; Asia & Asian America; Work & Education; Social Movements; Culture; Qualitative Methods; Experimental Methods

Publications

Lee, Jennifer and **Eva Chen**. 2025. “Review Essay: Race by Law for Asian Americans.” *American Journal of Sociology*. 131(2):460-71. doi:[10.1086/736726](https://doi.org/10.1086/736726).

Works in Progress

* Indicates equal authorship

Chen, Eva. “Assimilation without Settlement: Temporary Adaptation Strategies among Chinese International Students.” (*Under review at International Migration*)

Pérez, Katerine S.* and **Eva Chen***. “Minority Rule: Perceptions of Disadvantage in Higher Education.” (*Pilot*)

Chen, Eva. “From ‘Distant’ to ‘Settled’: Native Perceptions of Immigrant Temporariness.” (*Pilot*)

Chen, Eva. “Temporary Status, Permanent Disadvantage? Legal Status and Labor Market Outcomes among Highly Educated Immigrants.” (*Data analysis*)

Fellowships & Awards

2025	GSAS Conference Matching Travel Fund (\$400)	<i>Columbia University</i>
2024	Sociology Research Support Grant (\$1,000)	<i>Columbia University</i>
2024 - 2025	Lead Teaching Fellowship (\$2,000)	<i>Columbia University</i>
2022 - 2028	Paul F. Lazarsfeld Fellowship	<i>Columbia University</i>
2020	Phi Beta Kappa	<i>University of Minnesota</i>
2019	MSROP Fellowship (\$4,000)	<i>University of Minnesota</i>
2016 - 2020	National Merit Scholarship	<i>University of Minnesota</i>
2016 - 2020	Gold Scholar Award (\$40,000)	<i>University of Minnesota</i>

Presentations

2026	“Precarious Lives: Assimilation & Temporariness among Chinese International Students.” American Sociological Association (New York, NY)
2025	“(Dis)advantage in Higher Education.” With Katerine S. Pérez. Experimental Designs Workshop (New York, NY)
	“Safety First: Strategic adaptation and belonging among Chinese international students.” Eastern Sociological Society (Boston, MA)

Teaching

* Indicates weekly recitation sessions

2023 - 2026	Teaching Assistant	<i>Columbia University, Department of Sociology</i>
	<i>The Social World*</i> (Dr. Ryan Hagen; Dr. Marissa E. Thompson)	

★ Lecture given: “The Social Construction of Race”

2024 - 2025	Teaching Assistant	<i>Barnard College, Department of Sociology</i>
	<i>Methods for Social Research* (Dr. Amy Zhou; Dr. Randa Serhan)</i>	
	<i>Social Theory* (Dr. Andrew Anastasi)</i>	

2024 - 2025	Workshop Lead for Graduate Teaching Assistants “Best Practices for Grading & Assessment” “The Sound of Silence: Facilitating Discussion in Quiet Classrooms” “New TA Orientation”	<i>Columbia University</i>
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Departmental Service

2023 - ongoing	Gender Minorities in Academia <i>Coordinator</i>	<i>Columbia University</i>
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2024 - 2026 Race & Ethnicity Working Group *Columbia University*
Graduate Student Organizer

Additional Research Work

2023	Research Assistant	<i>New York, NY</i>
	“Anti-Asian Hate Compared: Origins, Patterns, and Responses in North America and Europe”	
	PIs: Jennifer Lee, Ya-Han Chuang, Hélène Le Bail	

2021 - 2022	Research Assistant <i>Committee for Children</i> Assessed user experience with Second Step®, a social-emotional learning curriculum for middle schoolers, through survey design, interviews, focus groups, and mixed-methods data analysis	<i>Seattle, WA</i>
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2019 Multicultural Summer Research Fellow *Minneapolis, MN*
Center for Urban & Regional Affairs, University of Minnesota
 “Productivity in University-Government Collaborations: Lessons Learned from the
 Hennepin-University Partnership”

2018 Distinguished Undergraduate Research Fellow *Minneapolis, MN*

Department of Political Science, University of Minnesota

No Longer Outsiders: Black and Latino Interest Group Advocacy on Capitol Hill

PI: Michael Minta

Additional Training

2025	Stone Center on Socioeconomic Inequality Inequality by the Numbers Workshop	<i>New York, NY</i>
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Additional Work

2024 - 2026	Columbia University Badminton Team <i>Captain</i>	<i>New York, NY</i>
2020 - 2021	Citizens Utility Board of Minnesota <i>Communications & Outreach Intern</i>	<i>Saint Paul, MN</i>
2020 - 2021	City Bureau <i>Documenter</i>	<i>Chicago, IL</i>
2016 - 2020	Radio K <i>Disc Jockey</i>	<i>Minneapolis, MN</i>

Languages

English (native)

Mandarin Chinese (fluent)

Japanese (intermediate)

Spanish (intermediate)

Professional Memberships

American Sociological Association, Eastern Sociological Society

Proficiencies & Certifications

Excel, Qualtrics, NVivo, R, SPSS, Stata

CITI Human Subjects Protection SBR (expires Jan 2027)